

SICC (688234.SS): 8-inch SiC substrate in expansion driving product mix upgrade; enhancing yield rate to support GM expansion; Neutral

We remain positive on SICC fundamentals and expect its revenue and GM to improve on the back of (1) increasing 8-inch product mix, (2) stabilizing substrate prices supporting blended ASP, and (3) improving yield rates supporting cost reductions. We expect the increasing contribution from 8-inch products to support the company's revenue growth, while continued product mix upgrade, yield improvement and cost reductions should drive GM expansion. As we highlighted in Sep ([report link](#)), management sees the rising adoption of SiC in EVs, penetrated into more budget level models, empowering fast charging. The rising penetration of SiC power semis in AIDC also brings upside to the company. As we highlighted in Aug ([report link](#)), the expanding applications of SiC in advanced packaging, AR glasses, and AR HUD, offer opportunity to the company's 12-inch SiC substrate, further driving its product mix upgrade and enjoy healthier competition. Maintain Neutral on fair valuation.

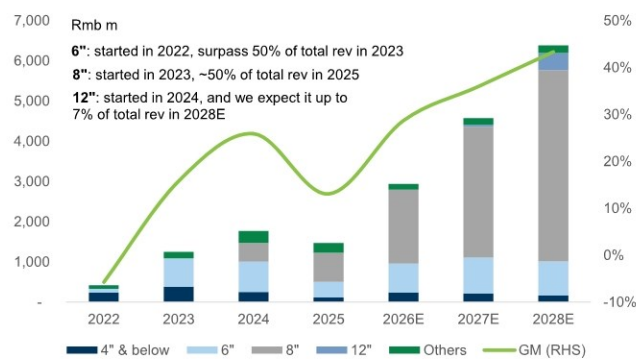
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Exhibit 1: SICC revenues by products and GM trend



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revisions: We factor in 2Q26 results and revise our 2026E-28E net income estimates by -26%/+4%/+7%. We raise our 2026E-28E revenue estimates by +3%/+12%/+12%, mainly on higher contribution from 8-inch products and better blended ASP as substrate prices stabilize. We lower our 2026E-28E GM estimates by -4.9/-3.7/-3.5ppts; nevertheless, we continue to expect SICC's GM to rise through 2028E, driven by increasing 8-inch product mix, improving yield rates and stepwise cost reductions. We lower our 2026E-28E opex ratio estimates by -0.3/-0.4/-0.7ppts, mainly on higher revenue scale.

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Exhibit 2: Earnings revision

Rmb m	2026E			2027E			2028E		
	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %	Old	New	Diff %
Revenues	2,851	2,939	3%	4,088	4,571	12%	5,684	6,383	12%
GP	960	844	-12%	1,623	1,644	1%	2,665	2,767	4%
OP	506	386	-24%	1,073	1,047	-2%	1,969	2,030	3%
Net income	481	357	-26%	973	1,013	4%	1,690	1,806	7%
EPS (Rmb, diluted)	0.99	0.74	-26%	2.01	2.09	4%	3.49	3.73	7%
Margins									
GM	33.7%	28.7%		39.7%	36.0%		46.9%	43.3%	
OPM	17.8%	13.1%		26.3%	22.9%		34.6%	31.8%	
NM	16.9%	12.1%		23.8%	22.2%		29.7%	28.3%	
Opex ratio	15.9%	15.6%		13.5%	13.1%		12.3%	11.6%	

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: SICC 2Q26 result snapshot

Rmb m	2Q25	1Q26	2Q26	QoQ	YoY	GS	Act / GS
Revenues	386	366	548	50%	42%	405	35%
GP	49	70	139	99%	185%	95	46%
OP	(28)	(19)	33	na	na	1	4592%
Pretax income	2	(61)	11	na	371%	11	-7%
Net income	2	(61)	3	na	13%	11	-77%
Margins							
GM	12.6%	19.1%	25.4%			23.5%	
OPM	-7.2%	-5.2%	6.1%			0.2%	
NM	0.6%	-16.6%	0.5%			2.8%	
Opex ratio	19.8%	24.3%	19.3%			23.3%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: We continue to use 2029E discounted P/E valuation methodology to derive our target price. Our target P/E is derived from peers' average ratio of trading P/E to forward-year fundamentals, including EPS growth and OPM. Based on peers' average ratio of 0.7x and SICC's 2029-30E average EPS growth of 14% and OPM of 33%, we derive a 34.6x 2029E target P/E. We apply the 34.6x target P/E to 2029E EPS and discount it back to 2027E with a COE of 12.5% (no change). Our new 12-month target price of Rmb118 (Rmb104 previously) implies 54x 2027E P/E. Maintain Neutral.

Exhibit 4: SICC peers comparison

Company Ticker	SICC 688234.SS	Company Ticker	Jingsheng 300316.SZ	Coherent COHR	ST Micro STM	Naura 002371.SZ	Starpower 603290.SS	Hua Hong 1347.HK	InnoScience 2577.HK
Rating	Neutral	Rating	NC	NC	Neutral	Buy	Neutral	Buy	Buy
2029E PE (TP implied)	34.6	2027E PE	55.5	26.6	21.6	37.3	29.1	69.5	93.8
2029-30E EPS YoY	14%	2027-28E EPS YoY	16%	21%	66%	54%	48%	56%	225%
2029-30E OPM	33%	2027-28E OPM	15%	26%	16%	23%	13%	6%	18%
Ratio	0.7	Ratio	1.8	0.6	0.3	0.5	0.5	1.1	0.4

NC: not covered, based on Bloomberg consensus; price as of Sep 18, 2026

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 5: SICC discounted P/E

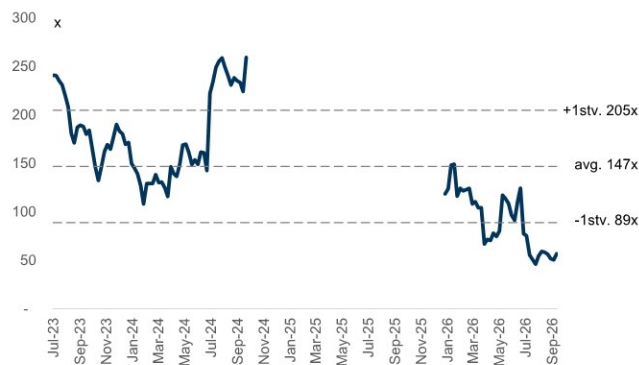
Rmb m	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Milestone	Semi-insulating (mainly for RF)				6-inch conductive (mainly for EVs)			8-inch ramp up (EV + AI)		Global expansion toward AI			
8" / 12" SIC substrate revenues contribution							27%	49%	63%	72%	81%		
SICC global market share		7%	11%	10%	6%	15%	16%	10%	17%	20%	22%		
Revenue	136	269	425	494	417	1,251	1,768	1,465	2,939	4,571	6,383	7,213	7,862
Revenue YoY		97%	58%	16%	-16%	200%	41%	-17%	101%	56%	40%	13%	9%
GM	25.6%	37.7%	35.3%	28.4%	-5.8%	15.8%	25.9%	13.1%	28.7%	36.0%	43.3%	43.3%	43.3%
GP	35	101	150	140	(24)	198	458	191	844	1,644	2,767	3,127	3,408
Opex ratio	29.4%	105.5%	185.1%	29.4%	60.6%	25.6%	20.3%	27.1%	15.6%	13.1%	11.6%	10.6%	9.6%
Change		76.1%	79.6%	-155.7%	31.2%	-35.1%	-5.3%	6.8%	-11.5%	-2.5%	-1.5%	-1.0%	-1.0%
OP	(5)	(182)	(637)	(5)	(277)	(122)	99	(205)	386	1,047	2,030	2,366	2,657
OPM	-3.8%	-67.8%	-149.8%	-1.0%	-66.4%	-9.7%	5.6%	-14.0%	13.1%	22.9%	31.8%	32.8%	33.8%
Non-op	(43)	(11)	1	89	100	66	60	6	(12)	72	64	64	64
Pretax profit	(48)	(193)	(635)	84	(177)	(56)	159	(199)	374	1,119	2,093	2,429	2,721
Tax	(6)	8	6	(6)	(2)	(10)	(20)	9	22	112	293	340	381
Tax rate	13%	-4%	-1%	-7%	1%	19%	-12%	-5%	6%	10%	14%	14%	14%
Minority	(0)	(0)	-	-	-	-	-	(0)	(5)	(6)	(6)	(6)	(6)
Net profit	(42)	(201)	(642)	90	(175)	(46)	179	(208)	357	1,013	1,806	2,095	2,346
NP YoY		376%	220%	-114%	-295%	-74%	-492%	-216%	-271%	184%	78%	16%	12%
EPS	(0.64)	(2.18)	(1.66)	0.23	(0.41)	(0.11)	0.42	(0.43)	0.74	2.09	3.73	4.32	4.84
EPS YoY										184%	78%	16%	12%
TP implied P/E									160	56	32	27	24

Target PE	34.6
Target PE x 2029 EPS	150
Value per share (Rmb, 2027E); Target Price	118.0

COE	12.5%
Beta	1.4
Risk-free rate	3.5%
Market risk premium	6.5%

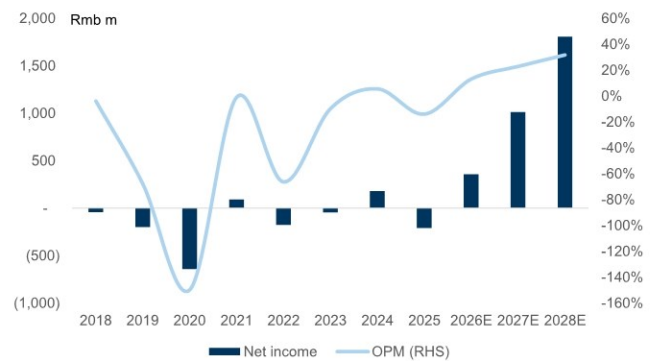
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: SICC 12M forward P/E



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: SICC net income and OPM trend



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: SICC P&L Summary

Rmb mn	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E
Income statement													
Revenue	1,251	1,768	1,465	2,939	4,571	408	386	318	353	366	548	985	1,040
Gross profit	198	458	191	844	1,644	98	49	66	(21)	70	139	284	351
OP income	(122)	99	(205)	386	1,047	(4)	(28)	(42)	(132)	(19)	33	156	216
Net income	(46)	179	(208)	357	1,013	9	2	(10)	(209)	(61)	3	176	238
EPS (Rmb, diluted)	(0.11)	0.42	(0.43)	0.74	2.09	0.02	0.01	(0.02)	(0.44)	(0.12)	0.01	0.36	0.49
Margins													
Gross margin	15.8%	25.9%	13.1%	28.7%	36.0%	23.9%	12.6%	20.6%	-5.9%	19.1%	25.4%	28.8%	33.8%
Operating margin	-9.7%	5.6%	-14.0%	13.1%	22.9%	-1.1%	-7.2%	-13.0%	-37.4%	-5.2%	6.1%	15.8%	20.8%
Net margin	-3.7%	10.1%	-14.2%	12.1%	22.2%	2.1%	0.6%	-3.1%	-59.4%	-16.6%	0.5%	17.9%	22.9%
Ratios													
Opex ratio	26%	20%	27%	16%	13%	25%	20%	34%	31%	24%	19%	13%	13%
Tax rate	19%	-12%	-5%	6%	10%	-59%	-5%	-246%	-3%	0%	89%	3%	3%
YoY													
Revenue	200%	41%	-17%	101%	56%	-4%	-21%	-14%	-28%	-10%	42%	209%	195%
Gross profit	na	132%	-58%	341%	95%	5%	-58%	-46%	na	-28%	185%	333%	na
OP income	na	na	na	na	171%	na	na	na	na	na	na	na	na
Net income	na	na	na	na	184%	-82%	-96%	na	na	na	13%	na	na
QoQ													
Revenue						-16%	-5%	-18%	11%	4%	50%	80%	6%
Gross profit						-23%	-50%	34%	na	na	99%	104%	24%
OP income						na	na	na	na	na	na	369%	39%
Net income						-76%	-72%	na	na	na	na	6531%	35%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - SICC

Valuation methodology: We are Neutral rated on SICC. Our 12-month target price of Rmb118 is based on 34.6x 2029E P/E. Our target P/E multiple is derived from peers' average ratio of trading P/E to forward year fundamentals (EPS YoY and OPM).

Upside / downside risks: (1) Faster / Slower-than-expected ramp up in 12-inch SiC substrate, (2) Less / More-than-expected pricing decline in 6-inch / 8-inch SiC substrate, (3) Faster / Slower-than-expected GM enhancement.

688234.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb118.00	Price: Rmb114.07	Upside: 3.4%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
Market cap: Rmb55.3bn / \$8.2bn Enterprise value: Rmb53.4bn / \$8.0bn 3m ADTV: Rmb1.5bn / \$222.2mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
		1,464.9	2,938.6	4,571.1	6,383.3
		Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	1,464.9	2,851.1	4,088.3
		EBITDA (Rmb mn)	147.5	782.5	1,530.1
		EPS (Rmb) New	(0.43)	0.74	2.09
		EPS (Rmb) Old	(0.43)	0.99	2.01
		P/E (X)	NM	154.9	54.6
		P/B (X)	4.5	7.3	NM
		Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0
		CROCI (%)	3.7	7.7	14.2
	EPS (Rmb)	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
		0.01	0.36	0.49	0.45

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 23 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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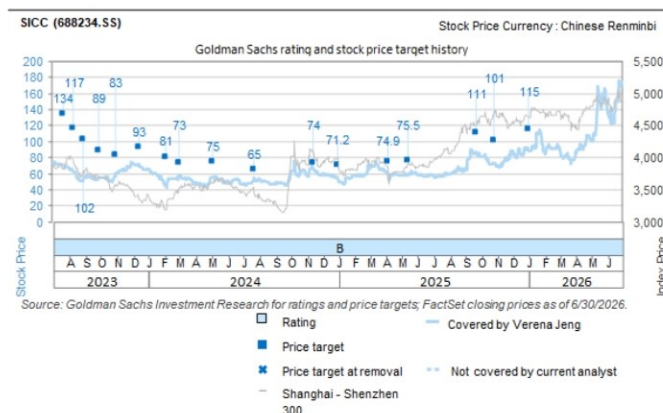
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Target price history table(s)

SICC (688234.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
03-Aug-26	104.00	81.39
01-Jan-26	115.00	88.88
27-Oct-25	101.00	73.86
22-Sep-25	111.00	87.58
14-May-25	75.50	58.51
07-Apr-25	74.90	51.56
31-Dec-24	71.20	51.20
13-Nov-24	74.00	66.22
22-Jul-24	65.00	54.81
03-May-24	75.00	55.54
01-Mar-24	73.00	57.56
04-Feb-24	81.00	45.01
14-Dec-23	93.00	72.00
30-Oct-23	83.00	60.17
28-Sep-23	89.00	54.90

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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